Definitions

A

Acceleration-sensitive nonstructural component: A nonstructural component that is sensitive to, and subject to, damage from inertial loading.

Acceptance criteria: Limiting values of properties such as drift, strength demand, and inelastic deformation used to determine the acceptability of a component at a given performance level.

Action: An internal moment, shear, torque, axial load, deformation, displacement, or rotation corresponding to a displacement due to a structural degree of freedom; designated as force- or deformation-controlled.

Active Fault: A fault for which there is an average historic slip rate of 1 mm per year or more, and evidence of seismic activity within Holocene times (past 11,000 years).

Adjusted Resistance: The reference resistance adjusted to include the effects of applicable adjustment factors resulting from end use and other modifying factors excluding time-effect adjustments, which are considered separately and not included.

Aspect ratio: Ratio of height to width for shear walls and span to width for horizontal diaphragms.

Assembly: Two or more interconnected components.

B

Balloon framing: Continuous stud framing from sill to roof, with intervening floor joists nailed to studs and supported by a let-in ribbon.

Base: The level at which earthquake effects are imparted to the building.

Beam: A structural member whose primary function is to carry loads transverse to its longitudinal axis.

Bearing wall: A wall that supports gravity loads of at least 200 pounds per lineal foot from floors and/or roofs.

Bed joint: The horizontal layer of mortar on which a masonry unit is laid.

Boundary component (boundary member): A member at the perimeter (edge or opening) of a shear wall or horizontal diaphragm that provides tensile and/or compressive strength.

Braced frame: A vertical lateral-force-resisting element consisting of vertical, horizontal, and diagonal components joined by concentric or eccentric connections.

BSE-1: Basic Safety Earthquake-1, taken as the lesser of the ground shaking for a 10%/50 year earthquake or two-thirds of the BSE-2 at a site.

BSE-2: Basic Safety Earthquake-2, taken as the ground shaking based on the MCE at a site.

BSO: Basic Safety Objective is a Rehabilitation Objective that achieves the dual rehabilitation goals of the Life Safety Building Performance Level for the BSE-1 Earthquake Hazard Level and the Collapse Prevention Building Performance Level for the BSE-2 Earthquake Hazard Level.

Building Occupancy: The purpose for which a building, or part thereof, is used, or intended to be used, designated in accordance with the applicable building code.

Building Performance Level: A limiting damage state for a building, considering structural and nonstructural components, used in the definition of Rehabilitation Objectives.

C

Cast Iron: A hard, brittle nonmalleable iron-carbon alloy containing 2.0 to 4.5 percent carbon. Shapes are obtained by reducing iron ore in a blast furnace, forming it into bars (or pigs), and remelting and casting it into its final form.

Cavity wall: A masonry wall with an air space between wythes.

Chord: See **diaphragm chord**.

Clay tile masonry: Masonry constructed with hollow units made of clay tile.